ACES

2k25

GENESIS

....Guiding Dreams, flourishing success

TensorBuilds

START-UP & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Presented by Rohan Marar



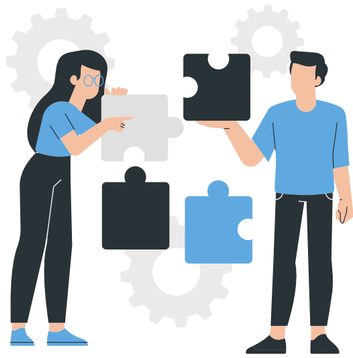




MY INTRO

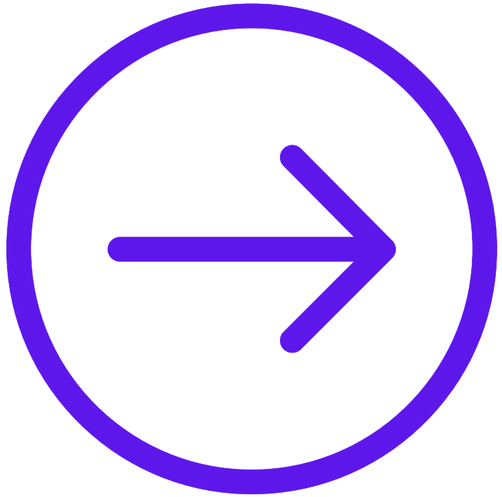
WHAT I HAVE DONE SO FAR

Quick disclaimer : I do not claim to be an expert in business or startups. Like you, I am just a student studying computer engineering, currently in my fourth year. This is only an account of what I have learnt in past few months.



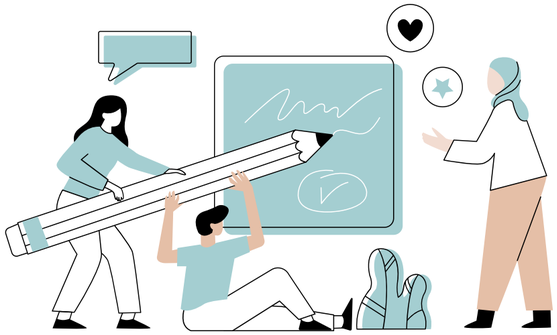
- Started my startup in August 2024
- Launched one basic trading dashboard app WealthifyAI, sold the first MVP at 50/- rs.
- Partnered with my friend Prathmesh Gawali in November 2024.
- Re-established the purpose of my startup. Started focusing on better problems and specific niche.
- Launched a new cloud service, InfraEdge, in first week of January 2025.
- Total profit made till now : around 350/- rs.
- Sold my book on Amazon, made 200/- rs from it. (not startup related)(but potentially a business idea)

How I got started with my projects and startup activities



Step 1: Find your niche

Find a problem to solve. A business revolves around solving specific problems for specific types of people.



Understand your passions and interests. This is crucial to keep you focused and determined. Know yourself first.

- Have a long-term vision.
- Find something that “aligns” with what you love, and what other people will pay you for.

For example, if you love watching movies, that’s something that you are passionate about, your personal hobby. But, it’s NOT something that others will PAY you money for.
UNLESS, say, you are a famous & funny streamer that reacts to watching movies. In that scenario, you already have a big target audience that you can MONETIZE.

Do what you love + what others will pay you for

- **You can do virtually anything you want : drink alcohol, play games, make reels/ videos, etc: ONLY if it attracts an audience/customers who PAY you for it.**
- **If you have a niche personal hobby or expertise, like coding C++ kernels or middleware, that’s something you love , but its not a good business idea if NO ONE will PAY you for it, where you earn a PROFIT.**
- **All businesses revolve around an exchange of perceived value & money.**

Step 2: Find the right partners

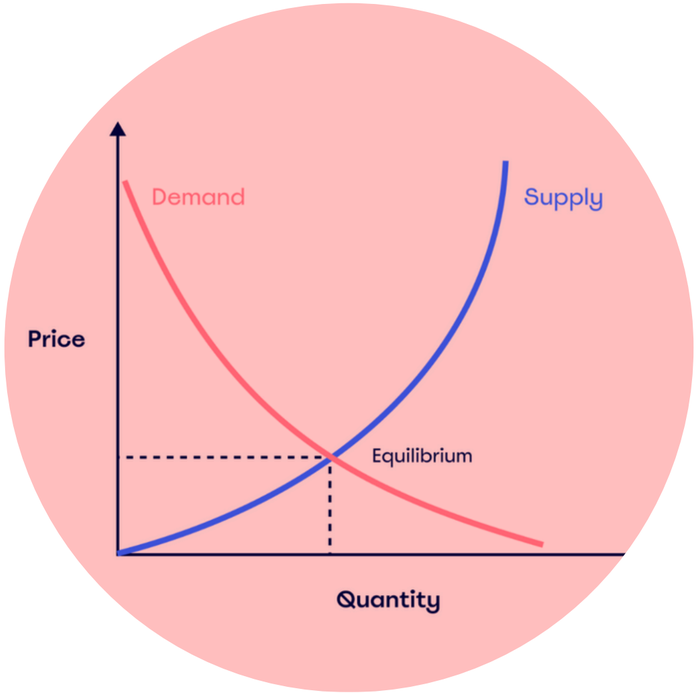


- Fun fact : Many businesses fail NOT because they have a bad product, services, or no customers. But because they have BAD co founders and team members.
- Even before you start building a product, or thinking of new ideas, first find the correct partners. If you can do it SOLO, kudos to you. But 99% of people WILL need a partner to start a business.
- More importantly : Find someone with a good heart and with good intentions. Avoid jealous, manipulative, or back-stabbing people.
- Even if someone is not skilled, or has zero experience, or is not intelligent, it DOES NOT matter.
- What matters is that they will support you through tough times, are not lazy, and have a passion to improve themselves.
- Understand people. Understand types of friends and colleagues.
- Learn to manage people effectively. Make it simple.

Example : Tony Fadell's startup Nest Labs ruined by Google merger & acquisition : wrong culture, wrong team members, only for-profit mindset

Step 3: Understand Your Market

Supply Vs. Demand



Is the marketplace growing ?

Is there a LOT of demand for your idea ?

Is it a supply-constrained OR a demand-constrained product ?

Example: you cannot be in a profitable newspaper business, coz the demand is declining every year. More people read digital news and articles nowadays.

The Value equation

Works for all businesses, ALWAYS

$$\textbf{Value} = \frac{\text{Dream outcome} * \text{likelihood of achievement}}{\text{Time delay} * (\text{Effort} + \text{Sacrifice})}$$

Minimize denominator, maximize numerator.

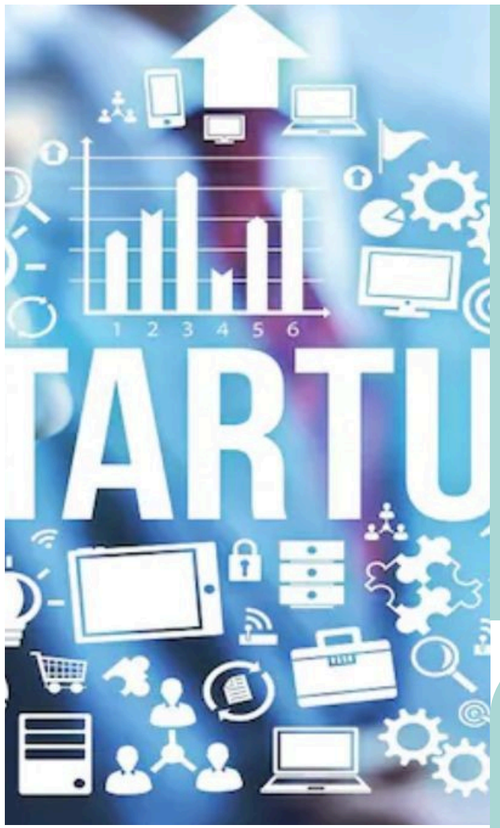
Most businesses focus only on the top part, but minimizing the bottom part WORKS the BEST.

Example : Gym membership

Source : Alex Hormozi

Step 4: Learn how the software market works

You can build a business literally anyhow: in stock market, real estate, hardware, retail, etc. The possibilities are endless.
I can give you tips only on how to start a software business.
In today's world, software is the easiest way to build and grow your startup. ZERO distribution costs, and easiest to learn.



A Private Codebase

Unless you plan doing business via open-source contributions and frameworks. Build your team projects, save your code files and data securely. Gives you a competitive edge and serves as your unique Differentiator.

How you sell it

Deploy on Cloud as SaaS ? Make a downloadable .exe file ? Make a web app ? Make a mobile app ? Use APIs ?

Innovate : Build your own packages, software libraries, methods of deploying stuff, new techniques, etc . Build a moat so that other businesses wont wipe you out.

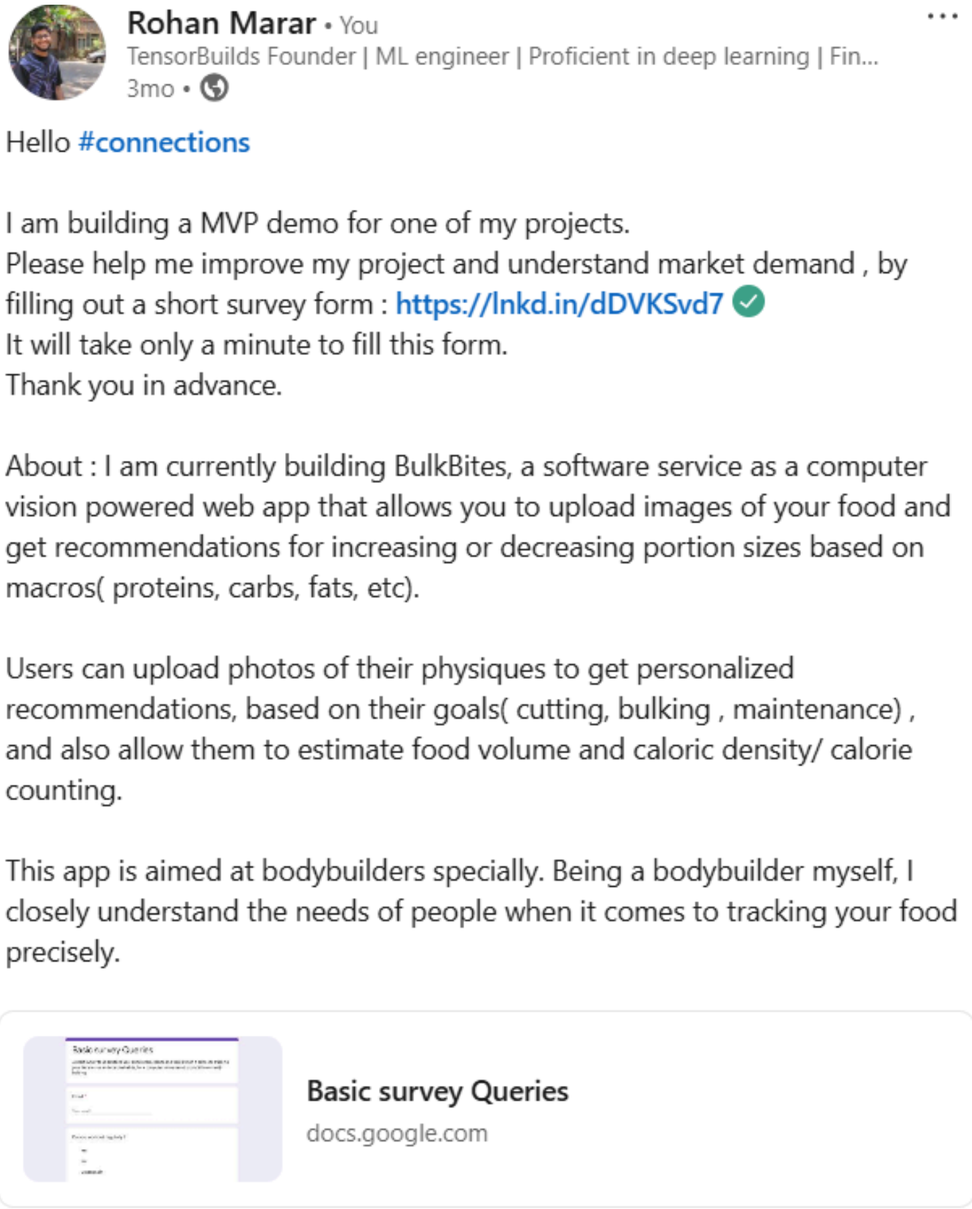
Dont get "commoditized". Dont sell alternative existing stuff for cheaper prices.

Example: Memory DRAM chips is a commodity business

How I have built TensorBuilds till now

Ideation phase: Deciding right ideas. What I would like to develop , and is it in demand currently ? I wrote down my ideas, **finalized** them, and then **focused exclusively** only on them.
I conducted surveys on LinkedIn, whatsapp, insta, Twitter and Reddit to understand demand for my ideas.
Note : Leverage your social media connections and followers to grow your audience, clients, and business. But if someone negates your idea, take it as constructive criticism, but DON'T discard it.

Learn the tech thoroughly: Before building **WealthifyAI**, I first learnt exactly how quant models, trading, finance market, stock data anaylsis, and ML models predictions works.
This involves understanding **core fundamentals** of your topic, using **first-principles basis**(like Elon Musk does).
Spend more time learning first. Do not rush things.



Rohan Marar • You
TensorBuilds Founder | ML engineer | Proficient in deep learning | Fin...
3mo •

Hello #connections

I am building a MVP demo for one of my projects.
Please help me improve my project and understand market demand , by filling out a short survey form : https://lnkd.in/dDVKSvd7
It will take only a minute to fill this form.
Thank you in advance.

About : I am currently building BulkBites, a software service as a computer vision powered web app that allows you to upload images of your food and get recommendations for increasing or decreasing portion sizes based on macros(proteins, carbs, fats, etc).

Users can upload photos of their physiques to get personalized recommendations, based on their goals(cutting, bulking , maintenance) , and also allow them to estimate food volume and caloric density/ calorie counting.

This app is aimed at bodybuilders specially. Being a bodybuilder myself, I closely understand the needs of people when it comes to tracking your food precisely.

How I have built TensorBuilds till now

I learnt how to deliver my app idea:

How to make a landing website with good design, how to construct a Payment integration.
As software developers, we can integrate a RazorPay(in India) or Stripe payment gateway to our websites or apps easily, with many metrics to monitor user purchases, orders, subscription plans, and much more.
Give customers a Quick and Easy way to pay you money.
Price your offering at a **PREMIUM**. Do not sell cheap, in hopes that more people will buy.

- Giving away valuable stuff, which you built with your hard work, for Free just because you are starting out, is the WRONG way to go.
- Price your offerings better, so that you can deliver MORE value. More pricing incentivizes you to make your product or service MUCH better. (example: my mistake with WealthifyAI)
- Make your posts, intros, video trailers, and other presentations with Attractive design.
- Offer **hooks** to attract customers : In my **InfraEdge trailer**, I offered additional Bonuses to early joining customers. Offer more value UPFRONT. Simplify your message to target correct users.

How I have built TensorBuilds till now

I learnt more about myself, and the field I love :

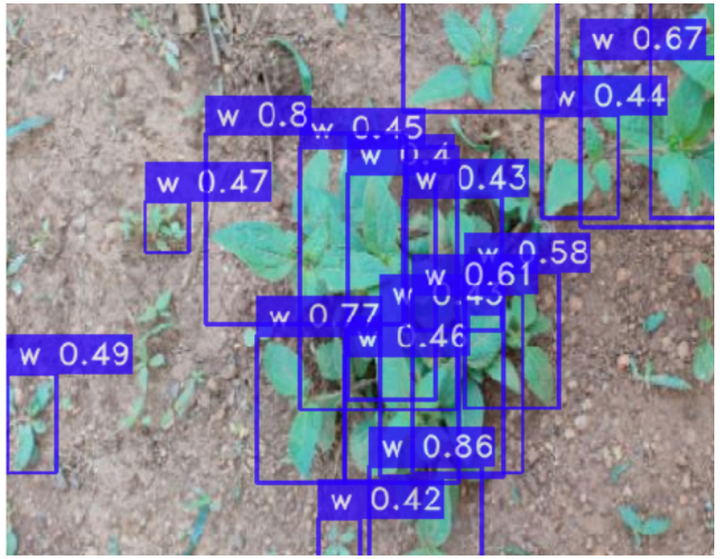
- All the fundamentals of programming with Python, data science, AI & ML (specifically deep learning with Pytorch, which I personally love to do).
- Studied both from POV of theoretical(neural network architectures), as well as practical coding aspect, and how to deploy the projects which I have built.
- Found out specific applications to build ML projects, that can be sold to customers to earn Profits. Learnt about what is in demand in the current AI market. Example: fine tuned LLMs.

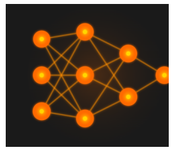
Object detection using transfer learning

A project where I ran various experiments on pre-trained object detection models and explored various fine-tuning techniques.
I came up with a new approach on how to train a pre-trained model on custom dataset and repetitvely fine-tune it.
Refer to the technical report in my repository to know more



Computer vision project : yolo-NAS Object Detection in Pytorch
A detailed project where I ran various experiments on pre-trained object detection models and explored various fine-tuning techniques....





How I have built TensorBuilds till now

I learnt more about myself, and the field I love :

- I hate traditional coding, such as DSA, competitive coding, etc.
- I focus more on understanding concepts and basic building blocks. The atoms of what I am building. **Example**: first I learnt how tensors work in ML projects, and how they represent data in various dimensions. I focus more on understanding the theory behind stuff, instead of memorizing codes or syntax, etc.
- Apart from Python and ML, I hate everything else in programming : no web dev for me.
- Instead, I delegate these tasks to my team members. Learn how to manage people, and distribute tasks, and incentivize them to complete it.

- I always write down my ideas in a notebook & set a timeline to complete and launch the project to the public.
- I focus on growing my network, be it on LinkedIn, insta, Twitter, Youtube, reddit, etc.
- Hiring interns (paid or unpaid) for your startup journey can serve as a GREAT way to **grow your codebase** and expand your projects. This is exactly what I did.

How I have built TensorBuilds till now

How I launched my software apps:

- Main website landing page deployed on Netlify & Vercel. Bought a custom domain name for it : www.tensorbuilds.tech

WealthifyAI :

- Code files (the main product backend) deployed on Render.
- Razorpay payment wall (API gateway page) deployed on Render.
- Landing pages for users/ potential customers deployed on Vercel.
- Project code written in Python only.

InfraEdge:

- Landing page on Vercel.
- Everything else self-hosted on my own home server.

ML projects :

- Cloud solutions like HuggingFace inference endpoints, AWS, Azure, TogetherAI , etc , with minimum Nvidia T4 GPU with 8 GB RAM is generally required for AI projects.

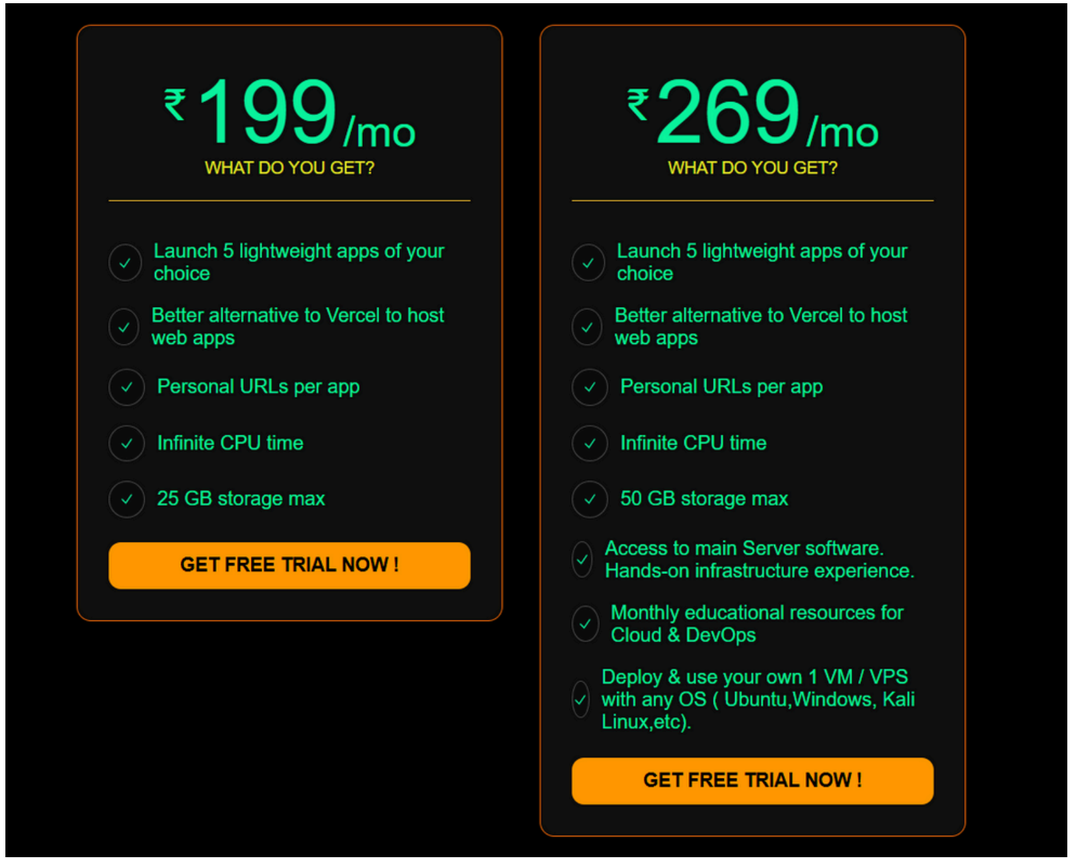
How I have built TensorBuilds till now

Our main page



www.tensorbuilds.tech

InfraEdge



Step 5: Start building !



QUICKLY build your first prototype



We call this the **MVP : Minimum Viable Product**. Basically, the smallest, most basic version of your idea, that you can **SELL** to earn money !





Iterate. Keep making better versions. Keep improving. Collect feedback. Grow your audience.



Do NOT get stuck due to Shiny Object Syndrome.
You HAVE to start somewhere. Improvise along the way. But just Start NOW!

PS: Even if you feel an idea is bad for your first product, start building it. Your goals and ideas will evolve eventually, and become clearer and better.

Problem-First, Tech later



- Steve Jobs made this mistake when he started out.
- He used to think : “ We have this great technology, HOW can we use it to solve people’s needs and problems ?
- Instead, we need to think: “ This is a problem people face, how can we use some tech we know, or like, to solve their problem.

PRO TIP : DO NOT FLOOD YOUR BRAIN WITH TOO MANY IDEAS



- If you have many new ideas when beginning out: make a list. Write down ideas.
- Then, keep them away for 2-3 weeks. Let the excitement wear away. Let those ideas marinate inside your brain.
- Give stuff time to breathe. What may seem like a great idea to you NOW, will seem like something STUPID to you in the future .

Problem-First, Tech later



- I spent 6 months of my life in frustration due to this : not finding good ideas to work on, and not focusing on 1 specific thing & thinking only from my POV.
- I went so far as to consider building custom PCBs (hardware components) & microprocessors from China, as a business idea!

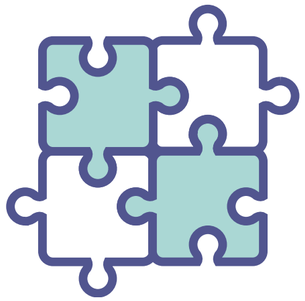
I LOOKED AT MY IDEAS ONLY FROM WHAT I LEARNT OR SAW, NOT WHETHER IT HAD ANY DEMAND IN THE MARKET.

SOLVE A BURNING NEED

- Customers are NOT always right. They can’t tell you what exactly they need.

Feedback forms , adopter communities , comments, etc certainly help you, but its also a good idea to sometimes listen to your GUT feeling.

- Make some prototype quick, for SPECIFIC audiences. They have URGENT NEED to solve their problems. **(Burning head, brick analogy)**



Sometimes, if you are not making any sales, or gaining any followers or clients, you are just sending your message to the WRONG audience , or are marketing in the WRONG way.

Discard noise

Avoid Unncessary hype. Example: AI + blockchain is STUPID.

Pro tip : Read latest news, watch good podcasts and edu videos on Yt for reference, and then absorb that knowledge & keep it for 2-3 months without seeing new updates or info. This will help you focus on what matters the most.

Do not try to impress others or absorb more knowledge than them.

In business, some things never change. For example: real estate will always remain valuable (Think : buying more real estate for growing new AI & data cloud servers of 20MW clusters, like OpenAI & Nvidia are doing)

Think different

Always think out of the box. Learn to adopt the “ Backbencher” mindset.

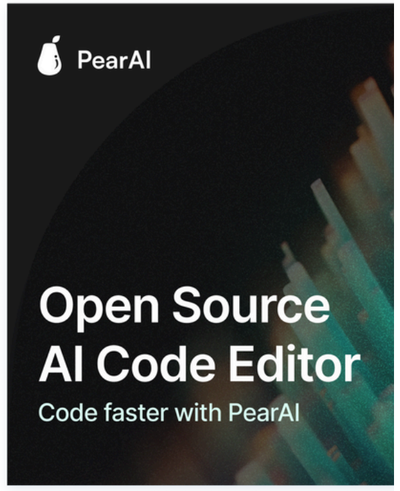
School and college teach us to avoid failure. However, without failing, you can NEVER build and grow a successful business.

Get ADDICTED to failure. Try more things, fail fast, learn faster. Do things with more volume.

You SHOULD have very HIGH pain + Patience Tolerance. Do NOT seek validation initially. Over time, your idea WILL gain traction.

Ways you can do a software business

- You can build in public.
- Announce what you are building, and document the whole process, including your mistakes, your ideas, etc.
- It has its pros and cons.
- Works great if you are building upon an open-source software framework.





- Build a private codebase or software framework
- Protect your ideas, software code, data & deployment methods via patents, peer-reviewed research papers, IP(intellectual property) documents, etc.
- Strategy followed by Microsoft.
- Works better than open-source sometimes (allows more incentives for premium products, well- defined software dev processes.



Elevate status of your customers

- Build a reputation for yourself and your products.
- Build something so good (BRAND) that it forms a collection of good ideas in potential customers, and raises their status(popularity, looks, efficiency, intelligence, etc)



Ways to market & scale your business

Warm Outreach

- Works best if you have many followers, friends & connections.
- Very effective for software products and services

Post free content

- Best for software devs.
- Document some of your projects as tutorials, educational vids, write blogs, articles, etc.
- All formats: audio, video, text, etc.

Cold outreach

- Only works good for service based startups.
- If you have clients for whom you build websites or web apps.
- B2B service basis.
- send emails, whatsapp chats, formal calls.

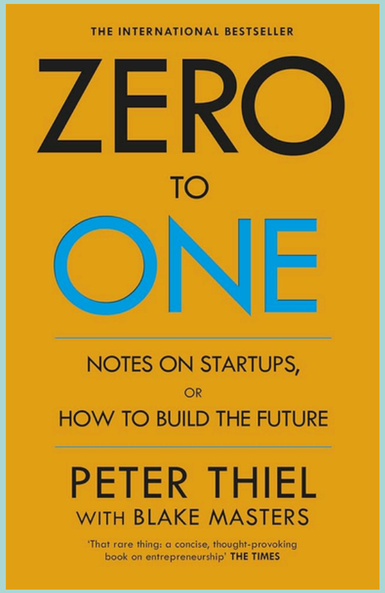
Paid ads

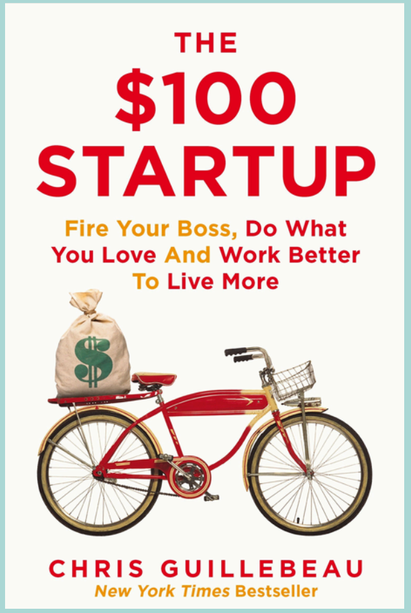
- I have never done this.
- Not good for bootstrapped startups.
- Only for companies with 3+ yrs of profit.
- Insta, facebook and yt ads.

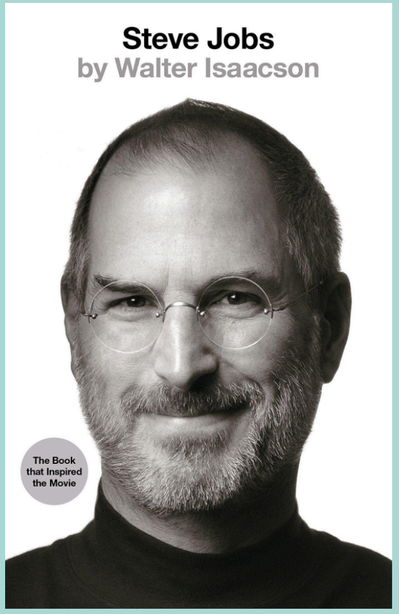
Source: Alex Hormozi

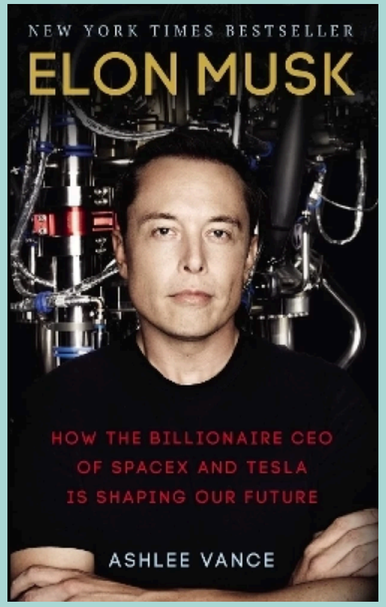
Some tips

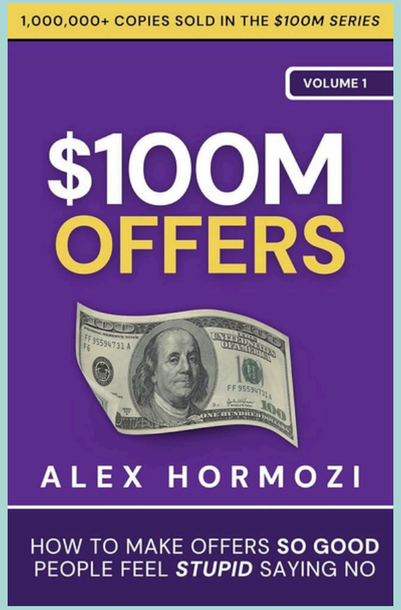
Books to read :



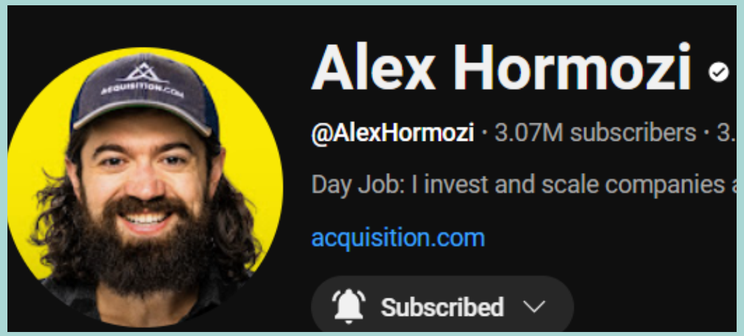




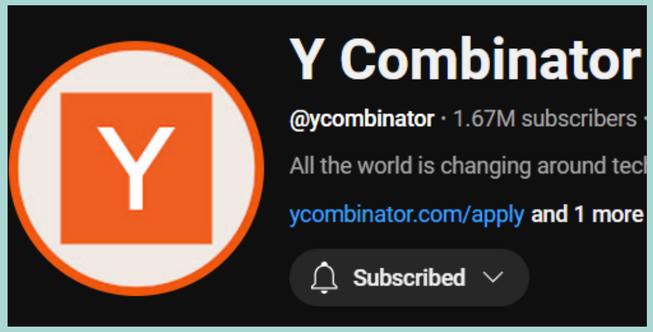




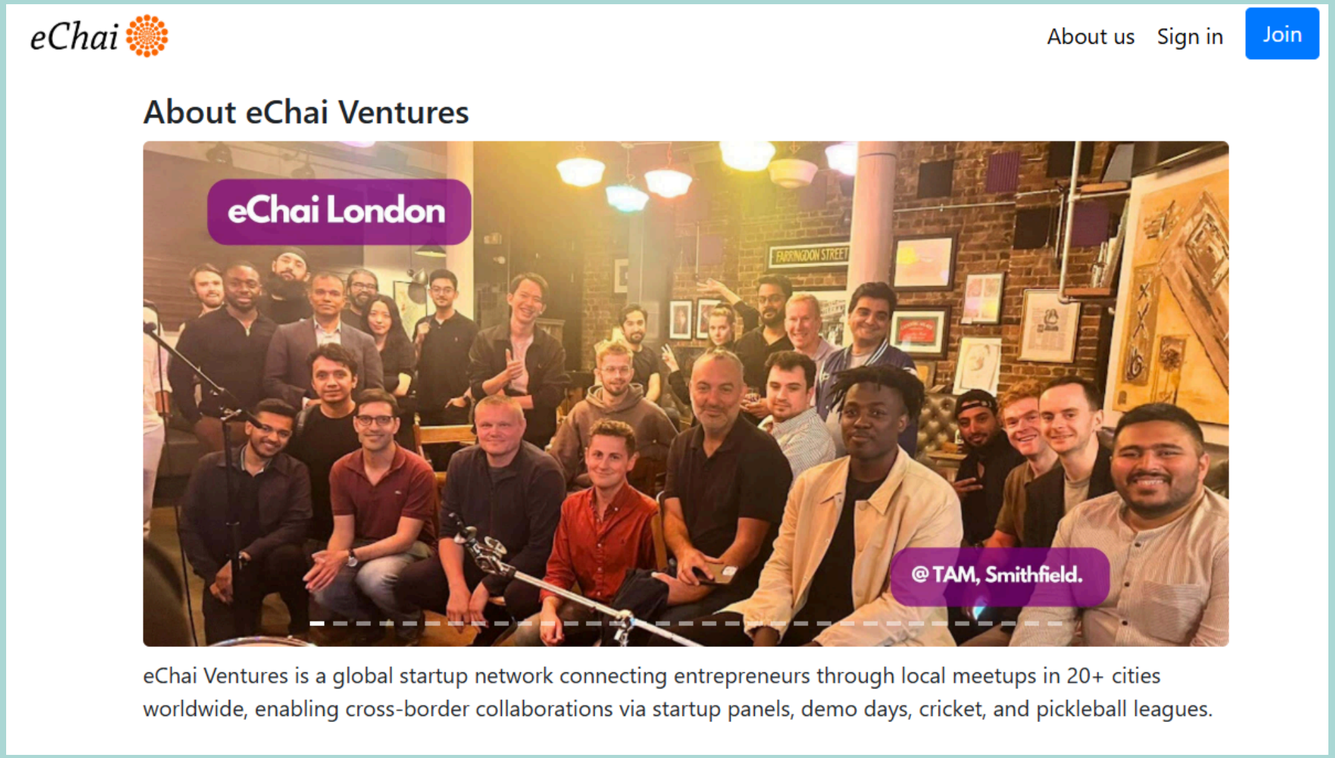
Yt videos :



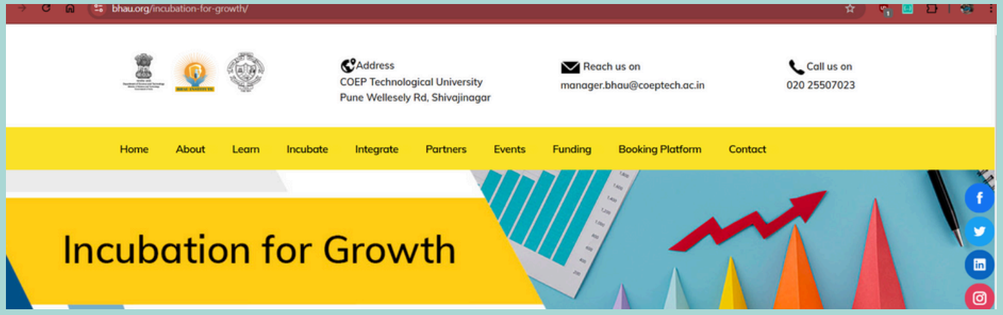




Some tips



COEP Bhau Institute



- **Get incubation, apply for grants, crowdfunding, loans or venture capital.**
- **Register your startup as an LLC via articles of incorporation & 1 bank account.**

Thank you very much!

Presented by Rohan Marar



https://www.linkedin.com/in/rohan-marar-77515a1bb/

THE FLOOR IS NOW OPEN FOR QUESTIONS